

Xbox and PS fans have to wait

According to reports, Microsoft and Sony do not plan to release their follow-ups to Xbox 360 and PS3, respectively, till 2014

Nook makeover

After modders ported android onto the Nook Color to unlock features like proper web browsing, now, B&N itself pushed it to Android 2.2 in the latest update.

Dell Venue

Sluggish beauty

The Venue is essentially Dell's second stab at the Android smartphone market, after the huge Streak. The front panel of the phone has the 4.1-inch display flanked by the glossy black coloured finish. The touch-based keys are placed below the screen. The stripe of chrome along both side panels gives the phone a classy feel.

The Venue is powered by the combination of the Qualcomm's Scorpion processor clocking at 1 GHz, Qualcomm QSD8520 chipset and the Adreno 200 GPU. Android 2.2 is preinstalled, but no real clarity out the Android 2.3 upgrade. Like other Android smartphone manufacturers, Dell has its own unique skin

wrapped around the Venue - the StageUI.

Despite being powered by a 1 GHz processor, there is a bit of lag in the menu scroll. On the 4.1-inch screen most images tend to throw up a bit of gradation in certain colours. The touch response is fantastic. The on-screen keypad is extremely well spaced out, both in the portrait and the landscape mode. However, the screen needs a higher resolution.

Funnily enough, in the mail application, we could not attach anything except a photograph to an email we wished to send.

The call quality offered by the Venue

is extremely good. However, the audio does tend to break quite a bit if the signal strength goes below 50 percent.

The images from the 8 MP camera are clear, as long as the ambient lighting is good. The 720p videos are smooth, with no visible jerk. However, the camera does have some shutter lag.

It has an impressive two day battery life. For just under ₹30,000 it is on the expensive side, particularly if you look at rivals such as HTC Desire HD, HTC Desire Z and the slightly ageing, yet very brilliant, Samsung Galaxy S, with the S-LCD.

Visbal Mathur



Specifications

Qualcomm Scorpion processor @ 1GHz, quad band GSM network, 3G capable, 4.1 inch AMOLED touch-screen, Gorilla Glass type, 480x800 resolution, 8MP camera with 720p HD video, Android 2.2 (Froyo), microSD card slot (up to 32GB)

Contact

Dell India

Phone: 1800-425-4026 / 080-2506-8026

Web site: www.dell.co.in

Price: ₹29,990

7.0
10

Features.....7.5
Performance.....6.0
Build.....8.5
Value for money.....5.5

Specifications

HD Media player; HDMI 1.3; Full HD resolution (1920x1080 pixels); HDMI video out; Component and Composite out; 2 USB inputs; Memory card reader; Built-in LAN capabilities; Picasa and Flickr access; Built-in Online Radio app

Contact

Aditya Infotech Pvt. Ltd

Phone: 0120-4555666

Web site: www.avermedia.com

Price: ₹5,500

7.0
10

Features.....7.5
Performance.....6.5
Build.....7.5
Value for money.....7.0

AverMedia HD Studio

For that theater, at home

Straight out of the box, the AverLife HD Studio immediately impresses with the extremely classy looks. In terms of size, this one is slightly thinner than the WD Live, but pretty much same in the width and depth.

The AverLife HD studio interface is pretty slick to use, the combination of sufficiently big icons and text works well. The home screen is laid out horizontally, while the rest of the menu is vertical.

Video playback starts up in a couple of seconds. Depending on the resolution you have set the media player to (480p, 576p, 720p, 1080i or 1080p), the video

will be upscaled to that resolution, depending on the requirement. What the AverLife HD Studio lacks is the 8-bit and 12-bit colour depth option that is available in the WD Live. The upscale was very good, without any extra artifacts making their way on to the image. Sharpness was retained, but a bit of colour gradation was visible in black colour portions, when upscaling a SD video file full 1080p. However when upscaling a native HD video to full 1080p resolution, there was no

such problem. This media player played back all video formats we threw at it.

Button layout on the remote is bad. It has a LAN port which allows it to be connected to widgets such as a built-in online radio app, Flickr, Picasa and can access and share files over network connected storage.

At a price of ₹5,500, the availability of a memory card reader is a value add. The remote is a huge disappointment, however.

Visbal Mathur

